3.1 Unit description

Introduction

This unit contains a practical written examination that covers the content of Units 1 and 2. There is no specific content for this unit.

Development of practical skills, knowledge and understanding

Students are expected to develop experimental skills, and a knowledge and understanding of the necessary techniques, by carrying out a range of practicals while they study Units 1 and 2.

This unit will assess students' knowledge and understanding of practical procedures and techniques that they develop.

To prepare them for the assessment of this unit centres should provide opportunities for students to carry out practical activities, collect and analyse data, and draw conclusions.

Students should carry out at least five practicals in class. By completing these practicals students will be able to:

- follow and interpret experimental instructions, covering the full range of laboratory exercises set throughout the course, with minimal help from the teacher
- always work with interest and enthusiasm in the laboratory completing most laboratory exercises in the time allocated
- manipulate apparatus, use chemicals, carry out all common laboratory procedures and use data logging (where appropriate) with the highest level of skill that may be reasonably expected at this level
- work sensibly and safely in the laboratory paying due regard to health and safety requirements without the need for reminders from the teacher
- gain accurate and consistent results in quantitative exercises, make most of the expected observations in qualitative exercises and obtain products in preparations of high yield and purity.